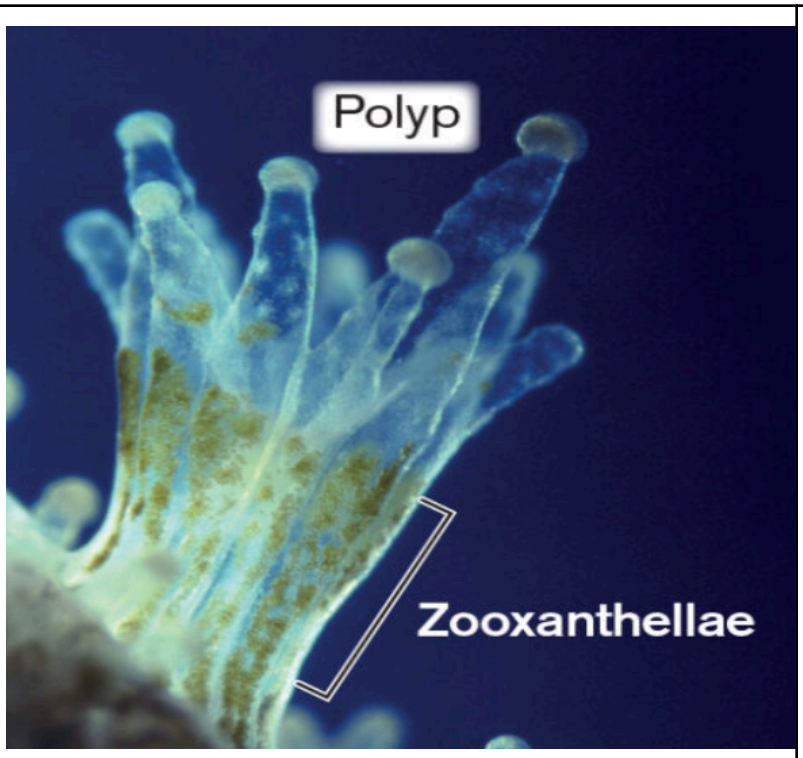
Coral



Microscopic view of a singular polyp

Characteristics- Corals are made of a colony of polyps, tubular sac like animals with a central mouth surrounded by a ring of tentacles. Such polyps can vary in size from several inches to centimeters . These colonies can rise to impressive heights of 13 feet corals can be of various colors of red, blue, green . They are filter feeders using small microscopic tentacles to catch food floating around themselves .Zooxanthellae are photosynthetic algae living inside coral tissues in a symbiotic relationship. They provide up to 90% of the coral's energy by producing sugars and amino acids through photosynthesis, help corals build calcium carbonate skeletons for reef formation,

Natural Occurrence - Corals form large systems called reefs which are mostly formed in shallow shelf environments in tropical-subtropical oceans. In rare cases some coral species do live in deep cooler oceans.

Fun facts - Coral polyps form structures called reefs, which are the largest living structures on Earth. The most famous of these is the Great Barrier Reef, stretching about 2,300 km in length and even visible from space. .